

wallet—and that made all the difference in the world. It changed the entire spirit of his life from that day on.

I make a speech. The above subhead is about as much news as “Dog Bites Man,” for I have made a great many speeches. Its significance is this: I made the speech at a small college, and while I was at the college I made a good many notes on some of their activities in the work-and-study area.

When the chairman of the meeting handed me my fee, I handed it back. I thanked him, but said I had gathered enough material for two or more articles in my *Golden Rule* magazine, so I felt more than amply paid.

Later, subscriptions to *Golden Rule* poured in from the neighborhood of that college. The students had decided that since I had done something for them, they would do something for me, so they had gathered those subscriptions. I was paid many times over. And so it goes!

What is the Golden Rule—really? Do you know that the Golden Rule in one form or another was old already at the time of Jesus? He gave it to us in the form most of us know, but here are a few versions which go further back in history:

He sought for others the good he desired for himself. [Inscription on an Egyptian tomb, about 1600 B.C.]

What you would not want done to yourself, do not do unto others. [Confucius]

We should behave to the world as we wish the world to behave to us. [Aristotle]

You can see that the Golden Rule has been set up for quite a few thousand years as a major rule of conduct among men. Unfortunately the world remembers the letter of the rule while too often missing the spirit of this Universal Injunction.

Say it this way and you are more likely to associate it with the kind of conduct that helps both you and others:

The Golden Rule means we should do unto others as we would wish them to do unto us if our positions were reversed.

Think about that. It is not quite the Golden Rule you will find in the Bible. It goes another long step, for it implies your judging the other fellow's needs in *his* terms, seeing the world through *his* eyes.

Forgive a bit of levity in the middle of a serious subject,